

KEEP THE PROOF — VERSION 2

Final Stage 2 QA pass

Prepared for Temidayo Afonja, The Density Group. September 18, 2026.

This pack records the final manuscript and product QA pass across the ten items in your review. It contains the correction log, the final legal-review list, the manuscript-to-Professional-Record consistency audit, the remaining decisions, and the research-discipline confirmation. Review only. No final designed PDF was generated. No LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED placeholder was removed. The legal review remains a production gate.

I. Correction log (this pass)

Item 1. Legal-gated language. – The whole manuscript was scanned for statements that could read as legal conclusions outside gated blocks. Findings and edits: the boundary sentence "The account is yours to keep. The artifact is not." now reads "As a practical rule, the account is yours to keep, and the artifact is not," tying it to the caveat and legal note already on that page. "Gather what is lawfully still yours" became "Gather what is still yours to use," with a pointer to the counsel-confirmed boundaries in Part Seven. Two remaining uses of "lawfully hold" (the reconstruction rule and the Supported certainty level) were changed to "already hold" and "hold" so no sentence asserts a legal conclusion. The account-versus-artifact caveat and its LEGAL REVIEW note (added in the prior pass) remain. No legal question was independently resolved.

Item 2. Proof Line boundary. – Audited all Proof Line and retrieval language. It was already clean: "Where the record becomes useful" names use-contexts and then explicitly stops before teaching interview, resume, or move mechanics; the retrieval page says the same. One reinforcement was added on the Proof Line page: "A Proof Line is general on purpose. It is a true, reusable sentence you keep, not a version shaped for a particular job, employer, or application. Tailoring your work to a specific target is a separate step, and a later one, and it is not this guide's job." Naming a Proof Line as usable "in a review, a resume, or a conversation" is retained as a use case only.

Item 3. Over-explanation. – Read sequentially as a customer. The manuscript was already economical; the completed examples carry much of the teaching and prose is short after each distinction. One clear duplication was trimmed: the Part Two opener repeated the "catch the work before it softens" line that the Quick Capture page delivers immediately after, and was tightened to "make sure the raw material still exists before anything else is done with it." No depth was cut; the standard held is substantial but easy to move through.

Item 4. Reader momentum. Confirmed. Results in Section 4.

Item 5. Ordinary language. The Plain-Language Pass is preserved. The ordinary problem is stated in plain words before the terms professional record, evidence, corroboration, and Proof Line. The product is not reduced to keeping receipts; the added recognition line and the Clarify part keep contribution, judgment, decisions, prevention, scope, evidence, and corroboration central.

Item 6. Author bio. – Rewritten against the actual career warrant. The bio now reads: "Her career spans nearly two decades and eight industries, across accounting and audit, cybersecurity, people and workforce work, diversity and inclusion work, and both consulting and operating roles." It states the through line as proximity to how work is evaluated and how careers are built, from several sides, rather than compressing the path into workforce strategy and organizational design. It connects two parts of that path (audit and cybersecurity; people, workforce, and inclusion) to why the guide exists, stays concise, and is not a resume.

Item 7. Factual and causal discipline. – Examples were audited for invented precision, unsupported causality, universal employer claims, overstated certainty, and any claim that documentation determines outcomes. One causal overclaim was softened: the people-development example's portable line no longer says it "retained" the analyst (which implies sole causal credit for their staying); it now records the coaching and that the person took a higher-level role, having been close to leaving. Elsewhere: no invented numbers (Maya and Devin deliberately avoid them); prevention uses "would likely have"; the employer-verification claim is bounded; and the explicit boundary that sponsorship, opportunity, timing, business conditions, and other factors shape outcomes is preserved in the Welcome and the edge-of-the-tool page.

Item 8. Professional Record consistency. Audit in Section 3. No contradictions found; no field change was required by this pass.

Item 9. Product boundary. Confirmed. The ladder is clean: the Starter finishes one accomplishment and one result; Keep the Proof builds and maintains the broader record; the Field Kit and Career Move Review interpret it for a direction or decision. No destination-specific decision work was absorbed; the Proof Line reinforcement in Item 2 strengthens this.

2. Final legal-review list

The complete set of gates after this pass. None removed; none finalized. The legal review is a production gate.

- L1. Not-legal-advice statement and confidentiality note (front matter). Carried from Version 1, held for confirmation.
- L2. Lawful ways to rebuild the record (Part Three): personnel-record rights, documents the employee may treat as their own, written permission, use of public work. Intent only; specifics withheld.
- L3. Anonymized process accounts (cross-cutting). Standard kept strict pending counsel.

- L4. Corroboration and privacy (Part Four; Professional Record Section 3). Role and observation only; flagged.
- L5. Reconstruction sources near employer-owned information (Part Seven). Governing note; boundaries withheld, cross-referenced to L2.
- L6. Account-versus-artifact ownership caveat (Part One). Practical habit taught; ownership questions flagged; no legal conclusion.

Result of this pass's legal scan: after the softenings above, no sentence outside a gated block states a definitive legal conclusion about ownership, retained documents, public artifacts, personnel records, colleague observations, post-employment reconstruction, AI and confidential information, or employer-owned materials. Each such topic is either taught as a practical habit with a caveat, or sits under a LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED note. Ten gated markers remain in the manuscript.

Also carried for counsel, not yet reader-facing because they do not change Version 2 instructions: work-for-hire and portfolio use; contractor versus employee ownership; client confidentiality layered on employer confidentiality; severance and non-disparagement clauses; preservation exceptions; employer AI-tool and monitoring policies.

3. Manuscript-to-Professional-Record consistency audit

Confirmed match, field by field, after this pass.

- Quick Capture, five prompts: MATCH (what happened; specific contribution or judgment; what changed; verifier role or permitted public reference; confidential detail to keep out).
- Full Entry clusters and every field within them: MATCH.
- Permission and confidentiality check: MATCH.
- Team result versus individual contribution: MATCH.
- Judgment and decision fields: MATCH.
- Prevention field, with "would likely have" honesty: MATCH.
- Corroboration, role and directly observed contribution only, no personal contact detail: MATCH.
- Proof Line ingredients (condition, your part, scope or constraint, outcome, support): MATCH.
- Reconstruction certainty labels (Known; Supported; Remembered but not verified; Uncertain): MATCH.
- Retrieval tags (review, promotion, compensation, resume, interview, biography, transition): MATCH.
- Maintenance cadence framing: MATCH (both present event capture and a periodic sweep neutrally).
- No field asks the reader to store anything the handbook tells them not to store: CONFIRMED.

The prose edits in this pass (bio, ownership softenings, Proof Line reinforcement, one example line, one trim) did not change any field, term, or instruction, so the Professional Record required no change. The printable/fillable companion structure is unaffected.

4. Reader-momentum and experience check

Read straight through as a paying customer.

- The reader does something early: the two doors and Your First 60 Minutes put them into real capture within the first several pages.
 - Your First 60 Minutes feels achievable: a timed checklist with a visible finish line and seven concrete outcomes, explicitly not a whole-product completion promise.
 - Capture, Clarify, Carry stays obvious throughout, and Clarify remains the most differentiated part, holding team-versus-part, judgment, prevention, scope-without-title, and corroboration.
 - It reads as a guided system, not a textbook. Recognition precedes education; examples carry the teaching; the one duplication found was trimmed.
 - Permission content sits where it is needed and cross-references the rule the reader already met, so it deepens rather than interrupts. Exact permission sequencing remains a test.
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5. Remaining decisions before design

Unchanged from the prior pass, minus nothing resolved here that was yours to resolve:

1. Permission sequencing: confirm the current placement (full standard in Part Three) or request a different one. Still a test.
2. Cadence framing: confirm the neutral presentation carries into design.
3. Routine labels: keep, rename, or drop Monthly Proof Sweep, Quarterly Proof Review, Quarterly Evidence Index. Still a test.
4. Quick Capture terminology: keep the field name "verifier role or permitted public reference," or align it to "who could confirm this."
5. Worked-example set: confirm the six retained plus the new examples (judgment under uncertainty, people development, relationship repair, returner, and scope-without-title in Clarify).
6. Author bio: confirm the rewritten warrant reads accurately to you, since only you can verify the industries and the emphasis.
7. Legal review: commission counsel on L1 through L6. Production gate.
8. Page-count range: confirm 44 to 56 as a ceiling.
9. Reconstruction separability note: keep it in reader-facing text, or move it to internal notes.

6. Research-discipline confirmation

Confirmed: no item that Research Pass 2 marked TEST BEFORE CHANGING, unknown, unresolved, or candidate was converted into a settled claim in this pass or the manuscript.

- Cadence: both approaches presented neutrally; neither asserted better.
 - Permission sequencing: presented as current design, flagged as a test; the standard is unchanged and load-bearing.
 - Visibility outputs: still excluded; the Proof Line reinforcement closes any drift toward application outputs.
 - Price, name, reconstruction placement: resolved by the approval briefs and unchanged.
 - The word "proof": name unchanged; the hierarchy keeps the meaning precise.
 - Maintenance and abandonment: not asserted in either direction.
 - All legal items: withheld to counsel; none finalized or removed.
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END OF FINAL STAGE 2 QA PASS